



TERMS OF REFERENCE

Gender and Youth Portfolio | Programme Specialist, Game Changers Coalition's Digital Design for Children

Team: Office of Innovation, Portfolio Culture and Scale (PCS), Youth & ADAP, Gender Equality and Emerging Area Portfolio

Duration: 6 months full time

Duty Station: Stockholm, Sweden

Level: P3 Temporary Appointment (TA)

UNICEF works in some of the world's toughest places, to reach the world's most disadvantaged children. To save their lives. To defend their rights. To help them fulfill their potential. Across 190 countries and territories, we work for every child, everywhere, every day, to build a better world for everyone. And we never give up.

For every child, innovate...

The Office of Innovation (OoI) works to catalyze UNICEF and partners' expertise and resources to solve key challenges facing children and young people, with a view to sourcing, accelerating and scaling the most effective solutions to accelerate progress towards achieving the SDGs. To achieve this the Office of Innovation uses an innovation portfolio management approach and leverages support from a range of stakeholders including from intergovernmental, multilateral, private sector, young people and non-governmental fora (think tank, academia).

Youth & ADAP, Gender Equality and Emerging Area Portfolio

The Youth & ADAP, Gender Equality and Emerging Area Portfolio is leading on cross-cutting issues to support and empower youth all over the world with innovative solutions to solve very specific problem statements as follows. **On the Gender Equality lens**, UNICEF's Office of Innovation and Gender Programme Group have identified key solutions connecting gender and technology for every girl to thrive, and benefit from skills, tools, policies, programmes, opportunities and access to innovation and technology in order for them to become the architects of tomorrow's digital world. This particular TA post will be situated under the Gender Equality lens of the portfolio and specifically under pillar 2 of Game Changers Coalition working on integrating the UNICEF Responsible Innovation in Technology (RITEC) learnings into the Coalition's work while amplifying its reach, its engagement and its advocacy footprint.

Game Changers Coalition

The Game Changers Coalition convenes strategic stakeholders with a shared passion to close the gender gap in the tech and gaming industries and in girls' Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts, and Mathematics (STEAM) skills. Through the Coalition, UNICEF is teaming up with private companies, civil society

organizations, governments and young leaders to equip and empower the largest generation of 600 million adolescent girls with the 21st century skills they want and need to become the future leaders, coders, and designers of a more inclusive, diverse, and secure digital future for all of us. The Coalition operates on three pillars:

- **Pillar 1 Build her Foundation:** Spearhead an innovative and girl-centered STEAM curriculum aligned with the skills girls want and need to engage with the gaming sector and the tech industry. This ensures a smooth transition from learning to earning, using behavioral insights to train teachers and also raising awareness among parents to support their girls to thrive;
- **Pillar 2 Build the Game:** Promote frameworks and practices towards a safe, diverse and inclusive tech & gaming industry for all girls and boys. Support tech & gaming companies in their journey to reach optimal diversity and inclusion practices including sharing standards and guidelines on business models and design with a gender equality lens, child rights lens and joint advocacy. Co-create worldwide local game jams and hackathons with adolescent girls to influence the future of tech content. The Responsible Innovation in Technology (RITEC) work will fall under this specific pillar;
- **Pillar 3 Build the Global Network:** Secure meaningful mentorships and reverse mentorships connections, global videogame hackathon and industry events. Provide access to internships and other experiential opportunities to bridge the gender gap in digital skills and advance girls' careers in the gaming and tech industries. The Game Changers Coalition is a unique adventure where key stakeholders get the opportunity to “walk the talk” on diversity and inclusion and help girls and young women go from playing, to learning, to earning. UNICEF's investment in a new game and girl-centered STEAM curriculum and a global mentorship programme through the Coalition stems from the belief in the scalability potential of the initiative.

How can you make a difference?

This role will support the Pillar 2 of the Game Changers Coalition under the supervision of the Portfolio Manager for the Youth & ADAP, Gender Equality and Emerging Area Portfolio. The curriculum design, delivery and overall experimentation and pilot phase of the Game Changers Coalition, under Pillar 1, is already completed, and the GCC is now entering its scaling phase where Pillar 2 and 3 are going to be at the forefront and pillar 1 will develop an online version of the curriculum. The successful candidate will act as the focal point for the RITEC design work and will ensure timely and quality delivery of the initiative to prepare the draft of a new proposal to the Lego Foundation after the six-month period of the TA will run out (for example with recommendations, principles design development/ adaptation/ enhancement/ upgrade, training material and monitoring and evaluation tools and initial draft of content).

If you love designing, playing, learning but also planning long term change and creating engaging and meaningful industry transformations, this TA is for you. We expect that you will ensure the latest design techniques and technologies are incorporated into the work of Game Changers Coalition Pillar 2 and are adapted to adolescent girls needs in particular but also to diversity and inclusion for all youth of all gender all across the world.

The post will be an integral function to the conception and delivery of innovative and fast-moving initiatives in the realm of responsible technology for children, involving collaboration with a broad variety of stakeholders and partners. Under the supervision of the Portfolio Manager, the Programme Officer will play a pivotal role in Building Pillar 2 of Game Changers Coalition to become an undeniable part of UNICEF's

global influencing and advocacy efforts on children's well-being and digital play, furthering UNICEF-led research findings under the Responsible Innovation in Technology (RITEC) project. The Programme Officer will also have to complete additional duties in relation to supporting existing workstreams on promoting child rights and well-being in online video games.

The Programme Officer will have the duty to amplify Game Changers Coalition industry tools and resources, primarily the RITEC Design Toolkit, knowledge management activities and trainings, including internal communication, and grant reporting on the achievement of concrete and sustainable contributions to national and international efforts to create a digital environment that both respects children's rights and supports their well-being.

Description of assignment

SCOPE OF WORK

The UNICEF's Office of Innovation is welcoming the RITEC research under Game Changers Coalition Pillar 2 and the scope of work of this TA will be to connect and amplify RITEC work as part of the broader Game Changers Coalition agenda. New research from UNICEF Innocenti and produced in partnership with the University of Sheffield, New York University, City University New York and the Queensland University of Technology explores the question: can video games contribute to the well-being of children and, if so, how? This research looked to the voices of the young, based on the scientific study of hundreds of children in six countries over many months. The research found something remarkable: digital games can indeed contribute to the well-being of children. They can allow children to experience a sense of control, to have freedom of choice, to experience mastery and feelings of achievement. Digital games can support children in experiencing and regulating emotions and help them feel connected to others and manage social connections. Children can imagine different possibilities, act on original ideas, make things, and explore, construct and express facets of themselves and others with the help of digital games. **But in order to support children and contribute to their well-being, games must be designed with their well-being in mind.**

This research was produced as part of the Responsible Innovation in Technology for Children (RITEC) project. This project was co-founded with the LEGO Group and funded by the LEGO Foundation and aims to create practical tools for businesses and governments that will empower them to put the well-being of children at the centre of digital design. The research forms the basis of RITEC's second report. The first report, released in 2022, revealed a newly developed well-being framework for children. Made up of eight child-centric well-being outcomes, the framework is a first step towards helping tech developers and policymakers develop a common understanding of how digital experiences can positively influence aspects of child well-being. Given these results, the TA will work on integrating the research outcomes into an implementation plan for a new proposal to the Lego Foundation and into concrete recommendation for next steps with the existing partnership of Game Changers Coalition with the Global Video Games Coalition GVGC.

SUMMARY OF KEY FUNCTIONS/ACCOUNTABILITIES:

- (i) RITEC Design Toolkit amplification and engagement

- (ii) Capacity building and knowledge exchange for Game Changers Coalition Pillar 2, including RITEC
- (iii) Awareness raising and advocacy

RITEC Design Toolkit amplification

- Drive engagement and awareness raising efforts around UNICEF's 'RITEC Design Toolkit'. Duties include developing a strategic plan for RITEC findings dissemination and leveraging identified opportunities to promote implementation of the Toolkit amongst identified target audiences globally through external collaborations;
- Conceptualize, deliver, and launch engaging RITEC introductory video to support by-in from expanded audiences of designers;
- Coordinate and strategically engage with RITEC project stakeholders, including companies, associations, international organizations, and policymakers under Game Changers Coalition structure and partnerships.

Capacity Building and Knowledge exchange for Game Changers Coalition Pillar 2, including RITEC

- Plan and contribute to the organization of Game Changers Coalition's events and speaking engagements at global or national level to promote RITEC project findings and core advocacy messaging under Game Changers Coalition Pillar 2;
- Respond to requests for technical support from UNICEF Country Offices in the different countries in Game Changers Coalition with a focus on the RITEC project and relevance to programmes;
- Provide in-depth technical support to partners and collaborators globally, including identifying new country offices or potential University partners to onboard in Game Changers Coalition.

Stakeholder Engagement and Advocacy

- Represent UNICEF Game Changers Coalition at external events bringing together online video games industry stakeholders and designers, including public speaking engagements; event planning; and conference session proposal writing.
- Lead or contribute to the development of awareness raising resources including blog posts, op-eds, updates to external website pages, publication Q&As, or related tasks as required.
- Maintain internal communications platforms (e.g. SharePoint and Yammer) as needed.

To qualify as an advocate for every child you will have...

- **A Master's level university degree** in one of the following fields is required: business, international development, human rights, sociology, international law, or another relevant social science field.
- **Minimum 5 years of work experience** in one of the following is required: designing digital products or services for children or children's rights in the digital environment.
- **Experience working in an international environment** on topics related to responsible technology, children's rights and well-being in the digital environment, or experience within the technology sector will be highly valued.
- **Strong research background** and **writing skills** are required.

- **Fluency in English** is required. Knowledge of another official UN language (Arabic, Chinese, French, Russian or Spanish) or a local language is an asset.

The following competencies are also required:

UNICEF Core Values

- Diversity and Inclusion
- Integrity
- Commitment

UNICEF Core Competencies

- Communication (verbal and written) (L 2)
- Working with People (L 2)
- Drive for Results (L 1)

UNICEF Functional Competencies

- Deciding and Initiating Action (L 1)
- Relating and networking (L 1)
- Persuading and Influencing (L 2)
- Learning and Researching (L 2)
- Creating and Innovating (L 2)
- Formulating Strategies and Concepts (L 1)
- Planning and Organising (L 1)
- Adapting and Responding to Change (L 2)
- Entrepreneurial Thinking (L 1)

View our competency framework at

http://www.unicef.org/about/employ/files/UNICEF_Competencies.pdf